

Maša Bešlin

Georgetown University
253 Poulton Hall
Washington, DC

✉ masa.beslin@georgetown.edu
🏠 masabeslin.com

Employment

FALL 2025– **Postdoctoral Associate in Syntax**, *Georgetown University*.

Education

2019–2025 **Ph.D. in Linguistics**, *University of Maryland*.

THESIS: Lexical categories, (re)categorization and locality in morphosyntax

COMMITTEE: Maria Polinsky & David Embick (co-advisors), Norbert Hornstein, Alexander Williams, Michael Israel

2015–2019 **B.A. in English Language and Literature**, *University of Novi Sad*.

2016 **Erasmus+ Student Mobility Program**, *University of Deusto*.

Research Interests

BROAD syntax and its interfaces with phonology and semantics, cognitive science

NARROW (mixed) categories, locality, raising, ellipsis, case, bare-NP adverbials, structure of the nominal phrase, argument/event structure, grammatical aspect, tense, Mayan, Slavic

Publications

MANUSCRIPTS

in prep **Bešlin, Maša**. Reconsidering Phase locality. *Theoretical Linguistics*.

in prep **Bešlin, Maša**. Apparent voice mismatches in K'iche' ellipsis: Consequences for the Syntactic Identity Condition and theories of features. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory*.

JOURNAL ARTICLES

2025 **Bešlin, Maša**. Active participles are (deverbal) adjectives. *Journal of Linguistics*, 1–34. DOI: 10.1017/S0022226725000155

2023 **Bešlin, Maša**. Revisiting passive participles: Category status and internal structure. *Linguistic Inquiry* 54(4), 729–758. DOI: 10.1162/ling_a_00463

PROCEEDINGS

in press **Bešlin, Maša**. On locality conditions for allomorphy and the ordering of interface operations. In *Proceedings of the North East Linguistics Society (NELS 55)*.

in press **Bešlin, Maša**. Missing verbal structure in BCS agent nominals. In *Proceedings of the Formal Descriptions of Slavic Languages (FDSL 17)*.

- 2024 **Bešlin, Maša.** On the incompatibility of two types of phases. In *Proceedings of the North East Linguistics Society (NELS 54)*, 79–88. University of Massachusetts Amherst: GLSA.
- 2024 **Bešlin, Maša.** DP in a model NP language: Evidence from Serbo-Croatian personal pronouns. In *Proceedings of the Israeli Association for Theoretical Linguistics (IATL 36)*, MIT Working Papers in Linguistics 95.
- 2024 Milićev, Tanja and **Maša Bešlin.** Word order in Old English embedded clauses: Syntactic instantiation and pragmatic factors. In *Proceedings of ELALT 6*, Annual Review of the Faculty of Philosophy in Novi Sad.
- 2023 **Bešlin, Maša.** Reanalyzing K'iche' as a tensed language. In J. A. G. Douglas-Tavani & G. Belmar Viernes (eds.), *Proceedings of the Workshop on American Indigenous Languages (WAIL 25)*, UC Santa Barbara Linguistics Department.
- 2023 **Bešlin, Maša.** Passive *v*P is not phasal in Bosnian/Croatian/Serbian. In *Proceedings of the Linguistic Society of America (PLSA)* 8(1). 5499.
- 2022 **Bešlin, Maša.** Raising as a free syntactic operation: Evidence from Serbian. In P. Kovačević, T. Milićev, & N. Milićević (eds.), *Proceedings of SinFonIJA 14*, Annual Review of the Faculty of Philosophy in Novi Sad. 63–86. University of Novi Sad: Faculty of Philosophy.
- 2019 Milićev, Tanja and **Maša Bešlin.** Instrumental: Why it is absent from the clitic system in Serbian/Croatian. In V. Lopičić & B. Mišić-Ilić (eds.), *Proceedings of Jezik, književnost, teorija*. 153–168. University of Niš: Faculty of Philosophy.

EDITED VOLUMES

- under contract* **Bešlin, Maša,** Katherine Howitt, Alexandra Krauska, Luisa Seguin, and Juan Uriagereka. *Structured sentences and the computational theory of mind*. Cambridge University Press.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- 2025 **Bešlin, Maša** and Sadira Lewis. Exceptives in Thai. In *Variation in Exceptive Structures*. Zenodo. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.16884105
- 2023 **Bešlin, Maša.** Exceptives in K'iche'. In *Variation in Exceptive Structures*. Zenodo. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.8059592
- 2023 **Bešlin, Maša.** Exceptives in Bosnian/Croatian/Serbian. In *Variation in Exceptive Structures*. Zenodo. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.7851016.

Presentations

INVITED TALKS

- 2025 **Bešlin, Maša.** Mismatches under ellipsis: Syntactic identity and theories of features. *Synsalon*, University of Arizona.
- 2025 **Bešlin, Maša.** Understanding the role of locality in grammar. *Friday Speaker Series*, Georgetown University.
- 2025 **Bešlin, Maša.** Understanding the role of locality in grammar. *Oberseminar English Linguistics*, Georg-August-Universität, Göttingen.

- 2024 **Bešlin, Maša.** What's up with 'verbal' morphology in BCS agent nominals? *Formal Descriptions of Slavic Languages (FDSL 17)*, Masaryk University, Brno.
- 2024 **Bešlin, Maša.** Is a unified locality theory nothing but a pipe dream? (And why that may not be such a bad thing). *Yale Syntax Reading Group*, Yale University.
- 2024 **Bešlin, Maša.** Understanding the role of lexical categories in syntax and semantics. *Institute of Linguistics*, Universität Leipzig.
- 2024 **Bešlin, Maša.** What's in Universal Grammar? On participles and the inventory of grammatical primitives. Presented at:
- *Princeton Linguistics Colloquium Series*, Princeton University
 - *UW-Madison Language Sciences Colloquium*, UW-Madison
 - *University of Florida Linguistics Colloquium*, University of Florida
- 2023 **Bešlin, Maša.** Domain mismatches in syntax and morphophonology: Consequences for Phase theory. *SynNYU workshop*, NYU.
- 2023 **Bešlin, Maša.** The Darwin-Plato tension, grammatical primitives, and linguistic principles. *Theoretical and Experimental Syntax Colloquium Series*, Hungarian Research Centre for Linguistics.
- 2021 **Bešlin, Maša.** A Mayan temporal puzzle. *Berkeley Syntax and Semantics Circle*, University of California, Berkeley.
- 2020 **Bešlin, Maša.** Theory and methodology in morphological analysis: A case study of passive participles, *Theoretical Grammar undergraduate seminar*, University of Novi Sad.

CONFERENCE TALKS

- 2025 **Bešlin, Maša.** Accounting for opacity effects at the form interface without the PIC (poster). *North East Linguistics Society 56 (NELS 56)*, NYU.
- 2024 **Bešlin, Maša.** What *actually* delimits the context for allomorphy?. *North East Linguistics Society 55 (NELS 55)*, Yale University.
- 2024 **Bešlin, Maša.** Apparent voice mismatches in K'iche' ellipsis: Consequences for the Syntactic Identity Condition. *Form and Analysis in Mayan Linguistics (FAMLi VII)*, Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México.
- 2024 **Bešlin, Maša.** Domain mismatches in syntax and morphophonology: The case of Bosnian/Croatian/Serbian adjectives (poster). *North East Linguistics Society 54 (NELS 54)*, Massachusetts Institute of Technology.
- 2023 **Bešlin, Maša.** Distinct locality domains above and below the 'word' level: Evidence from Bosnian/Croatian/Serbian adjectives. *Rencontres d'Automne de Linguistique Formelle (RALFE)*, Université Côte d'Azur.
- 2023 **Bešlin, Maša.** Temporal interpretation in K'iche'. *Workshop on American Indigenous Languages 25 (WAIL 25)*, UC Santa Barbara.
- 2023 **Bešlin, Maša.** Reanalyzing K'iche' (Mayan) as a Tensed language. *The Society for the Study of the Indigenous Languages of the Americas (SSILA) Annual Meeting* (online).
- 2023 **Bešlin, Maša.** Passive *v*P is not phasal in Bosnian/Croatian/Serbian. *Linguistic Society of America 97th Annual Meeting (LSA 97)*, Denver, CO.

- 2022 Milićev, Tanja and **Maša Bešlin**. Embedded clauses in Old English: Between syntax and pragmatics. *Formal Approaches to Embedding workshop, English Language and Anglophone Literatures Today 6* (ELALT 6), University of Novi Sad.
- 2021 **Bešlin, Maša**. On raising-to-subject as a free syntactic operation. *Crossing boundaries: Empirical and theoretical aspects of A-dependencies in complementation workshop, 46th Austrian Linguistics Conference* (ÖLT 46), University of Vienna (online).
- 2021 **Bešlin, Maša**. On personal and impersonal *trebati* ‘need’ in Serbo-Croatian: Implications for raising. *14th Conference on Syntax, Phonology and Language Analysis* (SinFonJA 14), University of Novi Sad (online).
- 2021 **Bešlin, Maša**. On the distribution of full object-pronouns in Serbo-Croatian. *16th Annual Meeting of the Slavic Linguistics Society* (SLS 16), University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (online).
- 2021 **Bešlin, Maša**. DP in a model NP language: Evidence from Serbo-Croatian personal pronouns. *36th Annual Conference of the Israel Association for Theoretical Linguistics* (IATL 36), Bar Ilan University (online).
- 2020 **Bešlin, Maša**. Encoding the eventive/resultative/stative distinction on passive participles cross-linguistically. *13th Conference on Syntax, Phonology, and Language Analysis* (SinFonJA 13), Research Institute for Linguistics, Hungarian Academy of Sciences (online).
- 2020 **Bešlin, Maša**. No such thing as a *verbal participle*. *14th European Conference on Formal Description of Slavic Languages* (FDSL 14), University of Leipzig (online), moved to June 2021 due to COVID-19.
- 2020 **Bešlin, Maša**. What’s in a name? The syntax of passive participles. *15th Annual Meeting of the Slavic Linguistics Society* (SLS 15), Indiana University Bloomington (online).
- 2019 **Bešlin, Maša**. On the categorial status of the passive participle in Serbo-Croatian. *Novi Sad Linguistic Colloquium 9*, University of Novi Sad.
- 2019 Milićev, Tanja and **Maša Bešlin**. Case alternations with temporal bare-NP adverbials in Old English. *English Language and Anglophone Literatures Today 5* (ELALT 5), University of Novi Sad.
- 2018 **Bešlin, Maša**. How often is *subotom*? Some observations on temporal instrumentals in Serbo-Croatian. *Novi Sad Linguistic Colloquium 8*, University of Novi Sad.
- 2018 **Bešlin, Maša** and Predrag Kovačević. An argument in favor of a rescue-by-PF-deletion analysis of P-stranding under sluicing in Serbo-Croatian. *EGG School Open Podium*, University of Banja Luka.
- 2018 Milićev, Tanja and **Maša Bešlin**. Instrumental: A curious gap in the clitic system. *Jezik, književnost, teorija*, University of Niš.
- 2017 **Bešlin, Maša**. The case of temporal bare-NP adverbials in Serbo-Croatian. *Novi Sad Linguistic Colloquium 7*, University of Novi Sad.

Awards and Honors

- 2024 College of Arts and Humanities Summer Fellowship, UMD
- 2023 Howard Lasnik Award for Distinguished Teaching by a Graduate Student

2023	College of Arts and Humanities Summer Fellowship, UMD
2023	Southeast European Studies Association Travel Grant
2022	Charles E. Townsend Memorial Award for outstanding scientific contribution to the Slavic Linguistics Society
2022	College of Arts and Humanities Graduate Student Travel Award, UMD
2022	College of Arts and Humanities Summer Fellowship, UMD
2021	Honorable Mention: Charles E. Townsend Memorial Award, Slavic Linguistics Society
2020	Honorable Mention: Charles E. Townsend Memorial Award, Slavic Linguistics Society
2020–2024	Dean’s Fellowship, UMD
2019–2020	University Fellowship, UMD
2018–2019	Serbian Government Scholarship for Gifted Students
2017–2018	Serbian Government Scholarship for Undergraduate Students
2016	Erasmus+ Scholarship
2014–2015	Woodhouse Grove School Academic Scholarship
2013–2014	The Headmasters’ and Headmistresses’ Conference (HMC) Projects in Central and Eastern Europe Scholarship

Teaching Experience

INSTRUCTION

FALL 2025	LING 8133 <i>Locality: From syntax to the interfaces</i> , Georgetown U. DUTIES: designing and leading a graduate seminar with 5 students, mentoring the students on their final research papers, grading, office hours
JULY 2025	<i>Introduction to Generative Syntax</i> , NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive and Linguistic Studies DUTIES: teaching an introductory class with 80 students, office hours
FALL 2022	LING 420 <i>Word Formation</i> , University of Maryland DUTIES: designing and teaching a undergraduate seminar with 15 students, mentoring the students on their final papers, grading, office hours
JULY 2022	<i>Introduction to Generative Syntax</i> , NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive and Linguistic Studies, with Dr. Paulina Lyskawa DUTIES: teaching an introductory with 80 students, office hours
JAN 2022	<i>Introduction to Generative Syntax</i> , NY–St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture, with Dr. Paulina Lyskawa DUTIES: teaching an introductory class with 60 students, office hours

ASSISTANTSHIP

FALL 2024	LING 240 <i>Language and Mind</i> , University of Maryland DUTIES: preparing materials, grading, office hours INSTRUCTOR: Dr. Margaret Antonisse
JULY 2022	<i>Verb-initial languages (emphasis on Austronesian and Mayan)</i> , The 4th Crete Summer School of Linguistics (CreteLing) DUTIES: preparing materials, grading, office hours INSTRUCTOR: Dr. Maria Polinsky

- SPRING 2022 **LING 312 *Syntax II***, University of Maryland
 DUTIES: preparing materials, grading, office hours
 INSTRUCTOR: Dr. Omer Preminger
- FALL 2021 **LING 311 *Syntax I***, University of Maryland
 DUTIES: preparing materials, grading, office hours
 INSTRUCTOR: Dr. Tonia Bleam
- JULY 2021 ***Introduction to Generative Syntax***, NY-St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture
 DUTIES: handling Zoom chat/issues, grading, office hours
 INSTRUCTOR: Dr. Omer Preminger
- SPRING 2021 **LING 200 *Introductory Linguistics***, University of Maryland
 DUTIES: leading 3 weekly discussion sections, grading, office hours
 INSTRUCTOR: Dr. Tonia Bleam

Research Assistantship

- FALL 2024–
 SPRING 2025 Variation in Exceptive Structures NSF-funded project
 PIs: Dr. Maria Polinsky & Dr. Eric Potsdam
 DUTIES: mentoring students in conducting fieldwork and writing up their findings on Thai, Korean, and Hindi exceptive constructions
- SPRING 2023 Variation in Exceptive Structures NSF-funded project
 PIs: Dr. Maria Polinsky & Dr. Eric Potsdam
 DUTIES: investigating the lexical, morphological, and syntactic properties of exceptives in Bosnian/Croatian/Serbian (native) and K'iche' (fieldwork)

Schools and Workshops

- 2024 *NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies*
- 2023 *NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies*
- 2023 *Eastern Generative Grammar Summer School*, University of Novi Sad
- 2022 *The 4th Crete Summer School of Linguistics*, University of Crete
- 2021 *Eastern Generative Grammar Summer School*, online
- 2021 *NY-St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture*, online
- 2021 *Ri K'iche' Tijob'al Keb' Tz'i'*, online intensive 2-week course in K'iche', co-organized by UMD, University of Toronto and Wuqu' Kawoq
- 2020 *Kab'lajuj Ey 2020*, intensive 2-week course in Kaqchikel at the UMD Language Science Center's Guatemala Field Station in Patzún, Guatemala
- 2019 *Introduction to Statistics: R*, University of Novi Sad
- 2018 *Eastern Generative Grammar Summer School*, University of Banja Luka
- 2018 *6th Novi Sad Workshop on Psycholinguistic, Neurolinguistic and Clinical Linguistic Research*, University of Novi Sad
- 2017 *Eastern Generative Grammar Summer School*, Palacký University Olomouc
- 2017 *Introduction to Neurolinguistics*, University of Novi Sad

Service

REVIEWING

- JOURNALS Annual Review of the Faculty of Philosophy, University of Novi Sad,
Catalan Journal of Linguistics, Folia Linguistica, Glossa: A journal of
general linguistics, Journal of Slavic Linguistics, Linguistica Brunensia,
Linguistic Inquiry
- BOOKS Advances in Formal Slavic Linguistics 2023, 2025, Language Science Press
Cambridge Handbook of Comparative Syntax, Cambridge University Press
Semantics of Slavic Languages, Language Science Press
- CONFERENCES Formal Approaches to Slavic Linguistics (FASL 34)
Formal Descriptions of Slavic Languages (FDSL 17)
Syntax, Phonology, and Language Analysis (SinFonIJA 14, 16, & 17)
The Society for the Study of the Indigenous Languages of the Americas
Annual Meeting (SSILA 2025 & 2026)

OTHER SERVICE

- 2022– Proofreader for Language Science Press
- 2025 Member of the Department Framing Committee, Georgetown University
- 2024 Co-organizer for *Mayfest 2024* in honor of Masha Polinsky, UMD
- 2023 Co-organizer for *Mayfest 2023* in honor of Howard Lasnik, UMD
- 2022 Co-organizer for *Mayfest 2020(+2)* in honor of Norbert Hornstein, UMD
- 2022 Volunteer at *Maryland Day*, open house at UMD for the local community
- 2022 Proctor for the *North American Computational Linguistics Olympiad*
- 2021–2023 Student Representative for the Linguistics department, Dean’s Graduate
Advisory Board, UMD
- 2021 Co-organizer for *Syntax, Phonology and Language Analysis 14 (SinFonIJA
14)*, University of Novi Sad (online)
- 2020–2021 Co-organizer, General Linguistics Lab Meeting, UMD
- 2018 Co-author and coordinator of the *Universal Grammar and Language Abil-
ity* workshop at the International Festival of Science and Education, Uni-
versity of Novi Sad

Work Experience

- 2015– Freelance translator English>Serbian, Spanish>Serbian, Serbian>English
- 2018 Interpreter (Spanish>Serbian, Serbian>Spanish) at *Koteks Viscofan* in
Novi Sad, Serbia
- 2016–2019 Tutor for the courses English grammar 3, English Grammar 4, Generative
Syntax 1 and Generative Syntax 2 at the University of Novi Sad
- 2015–2018 Freelance language teacher for English and Spanish

Professional Membership

- 2022– Society for the Study of Indigenous Languages of the Americas (SSILA)
- 2020– Linguistic Society of America (LSA)

2020– Slavic Linguistics Society (SLS)

Technical Skills

MS Office, PsychoPy, SPSS, L^AT_EX

Languages

<i>native</i>	Serbian (Bosnian/Croatian/Serbian)
<i>fluent</i>	English, Spanish
<i>beginner</i>	German
<i>fieldwork</i>	K'iche', Kaqchikel

References (in order)

Professor Maria Polinsky

University of Maryland
1417A Marie Mount Hall
College Park, MD 20742
polinsky@umd.edu

Professor David Embick

University of Pennsylvania
3401-C Walnut Street, Suite 300C
Philadelphia, PA 19104-6228
embick@ling.upenn.edu

Associate Professor Ruth Kramer

Georgetown University
251 Poulton Hall
Washington, DC 20057
rtk8@georgetown.edu

Professor Norbert Hornstein

University of Maryland
3416G Marie Mount Hall
College Park, MD 20742
nhornste@umd.edu

Associate Professor Tanja Milićev

University of Novi Sad
Dr Zorana Đinđića 2,
21000 Novi Sad
tanja.milicev@ff.uns.ac.rs

Dr. Tonia Bleam

University of Maryland
1401E Marie Mount Hall
College Park, MD 20742
tbleam@umd.edu